

ES Muunraad

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Sacred Space 2018

About this Class

The heirloom healing Deitsch (Pennsylvania German) practice of Braucherei (also called Powwow in English) and the related magical practice of Hexerei serve as tremendous folk resources for the Heathen denomination of Urglaawe.

Long the front line of folk medicine for the Deitsch people, Braucherei is pre-Christian at its core and features overlays from Gnostic, Judeo-Christian, and Lenape traditions.

The practitioner communities also retained a large volume of oral lore in the form of myths, “superstitions,” charms, etc. The Urglaawe movement arose from these living Heathen traditions as well as from the wider Deitsch folk religion. Urglaawe features the Heathen elements still living within the Deitsch culture, drawing much of its knowledge from Braucherei and Hexerei lore.

The Urglaawe community is now working to make this knowledge more accessible to the Urglaawe community inside and outside of Pennsylvania.

About this Class

- MUUN or MUUNET
 - A god in the Urglaawe pantheon
 - Not the Moon itself but represents the power of Muun
 - Not a sibling of Sunna but instead a star-crossed lover
 - Lineage unclear but counted among the Wane
 - Sunna and Sinthgunt counted among the Ase (possibly, though not clearly, as daughters of Ziu)

Es Yaahrsraad

- Wheel of the Year – Es Yaahresraad
 - “On a tilt”
 - Yuul – Yule – Solar New Year
 - Neiyaahrsdaag - New Year’s Day – Calendar New Year
 - Oschdre – Spring Equinox – Spiritual and Lunar New Year
- Synchronized to Greek solar zodiac
 - Syncretic and Christian Brauchers
 - Limited to twelve signs
 - Sign features match Greek-derived astrology

Es Muunraad

- Lunar Reckoning
 - Northeastern Pennsylvania
 - Hexerei practitioners
 - Some Christian practitioners
 - Signs have unique personalities
 - Similarities to and Differences from Greek signs
 - Begins at first New Moon after the Spring Equinox
 - Thirteen signs
 - Varies from calendar year to calendar year
 - Standard Time
 - Schtarricki Zeit (SZ): Daylight Savings Time
 - Langsami Zeit (LZ): Standard Time

The Big Questions!

- Where does this come from?
 - Germanic lore
 - Lenape traditions?
 - Unique to Pennsylvania?
- What is it used for?
 - In Braucherei
 - In Hexerei
 - In Agriculture
 - In Blanzeheilkunscht

Moon Lore

New Moon

- Sweep house at new moon to keep moths and spiders away
- Cut fingernails and toenails at new moon (place under Elder)
- Harvest catnip, horehound, herbs for diminishing problems

Waxing Moon

- Planting crops for which aerial parts are used
- Magical practices for increasing
- Boil soap, butcher, marry, move/relocate,

Full Moon

- Moon shining on one's bed leads to mental illness or blindness
- Do not risk conceiving a child in the light of the full moon; no nursing
- Harvest lavender, lemon balm, herbs for strengthening mind, body, soul

Waning Moon

- Planting crops for which underground parts are used
- Cut corn AND corns during the waning moon
- Magical practices for decreasing
- Do not cut hair in waning moon
- Make wine

Moon Lore

- Cold Moon
 - Different from American lore
 - High in the horizon or far north
 - Good time to “freeze” things out
- Horns of the Moon – Special Power
 - Upward vs. Downward Energy
 - Moon with horns up, do not plant permanent items (e.g., fence posts) in ground
 - Horns down: Shingle roofs, plant onions
- Do not plant potatoes on a Monday
- Never thank a human for plants in the garden.
- Greet anything flowering on New Year’s Day
- Ring around the moon predicts foul weather

Big Picture Concepts

- The Muunraad is part of the dance between Sunna and Muun
- Eclipses have altering effects on the personalities of the signs
- Linguistic (and psycho-spiritual) connections among the Moon, Time, and Tides
- Man in the Moon, Schlumm, Sandman, and other figures from Deutsch lore

Man in the Moon

- Muunkall (Moon Fellow) in Deutsch
- Not Muun Himself
 - Trickster
 - Thief
 - Wood (his original crime, Christian era)
 - Vegetables
 - Clothes
 - Butzemann
 - Kidnapper
 - His original crime (Heathen lore)
 - Scandinavians recite the names Bil and Hiuki
 - Cattle Injury
 - Muunkalb

Man in the Moon

A Tale of the Man in the Moon (abridged)

A man once went hunting in the woods of Yellow Mountain (Berks County) during the last quarter of the moon. When he loaded his gun to shoot at a deer he saw, he hung his powder horn on a horn of the moon, not thinking it odd to be able to do so. After he shot the deer, the moon had risen so high that he could not reach his horn anymore. He piled wood to stand on, but the moon kept rising out of his reach until his horn was gone. As he came home, he told his neighbors and family about what happened, and they told him that his horn had been stolen by the Man in the Moon. One neighbor, a Hex, advised him to return to that same spot at the new moon. He did so, and he found his powder horn next to the pile of wood he had stood on.

der Schadde

- Trickster Giant
- Jealous courter of Sunna
- Knows others' desires and exploits them
- Keeps Sunna and Muun apart by tricking Schlumm

der Schlumm

- God associated with sleep
 - Some say a Dwarf
 - Others say a son of Muun born in the Lakes of the Unnergegend
 - Wants to walk among the wakened
 - Darts
 - Shoots the sun and/or the moon and puts them to sleep
 - Communicates through riddles
 - Asks of Wudan to make amends
 - Schadde cannot in the light of the Sun
 - Eclipses
 - Story of Balder?

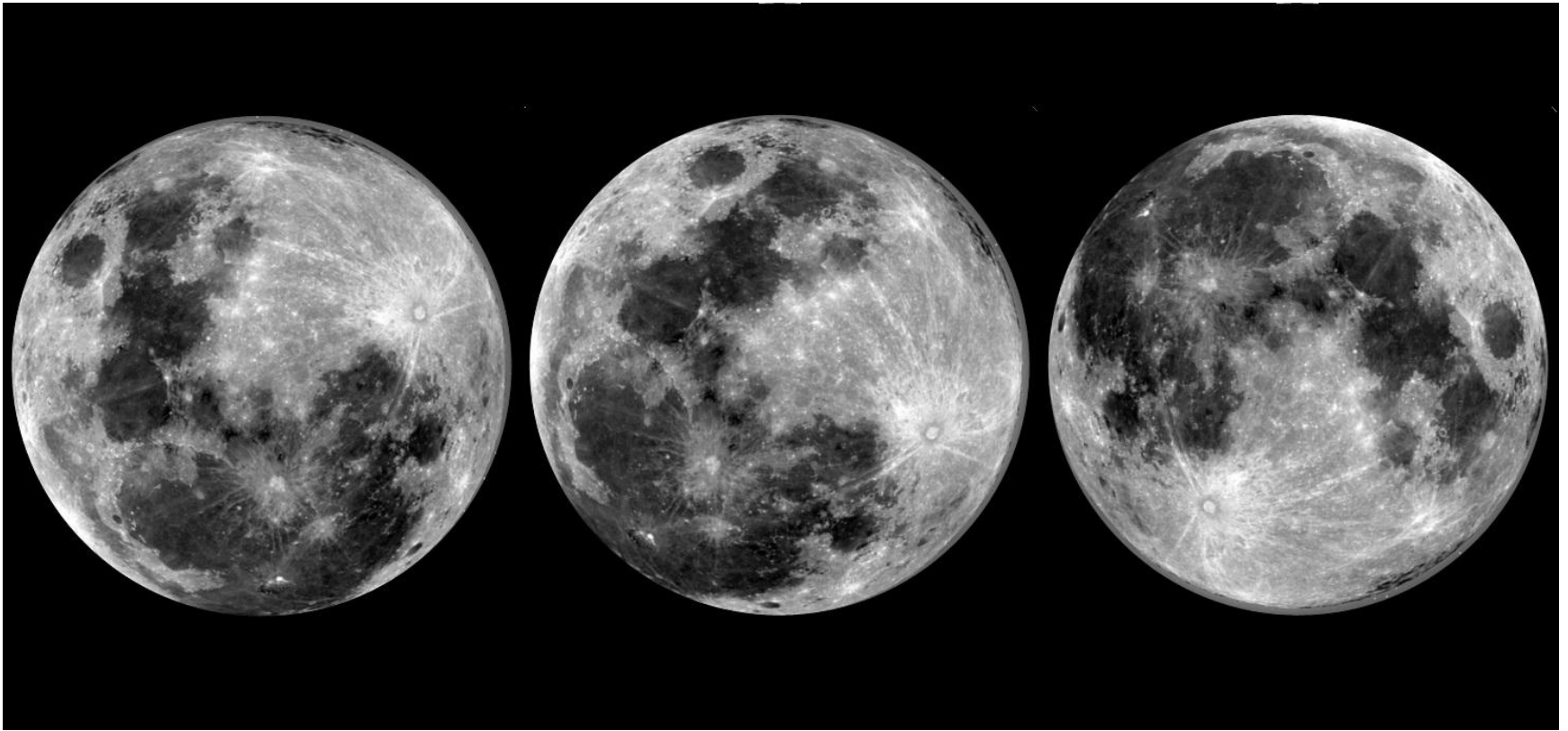
der Sandmann

- May also reside on the moon
- Puts people to sleep by blowing sand in their eyes
- Impish character but not necessarily malevolent

More Big Picture Concepts

- In 2018, there is a New Moon on March 17. This is still a 2017 moon (Haas/Elbedritsch)
- Spring Equinox falls on March 20, 2018, at 11:15 PM (Allentown LZ)
 - Haasmuun still in effect
- Muunraad will reset on April 15 at 8:57 PM (Allentown LZ)
- Phases of the moon matter
- Southern hemisphere and Equator

Moon from South, Equator, North



1: Holzhaahne / Woodcock

- DER HOLZHAAHNE – WOODCOCK



1: Holzhaahne / Woodcock

PERSONALITY FEATURES – Good, Bad, Neutral

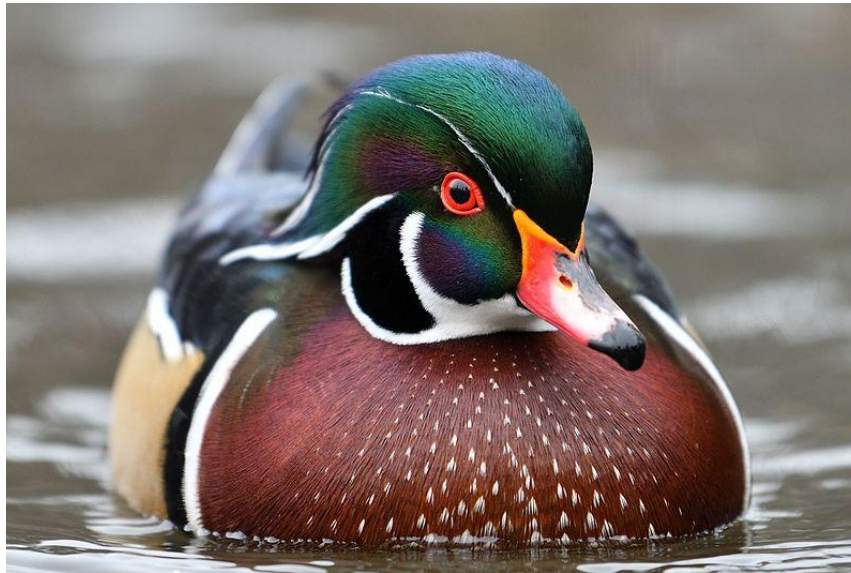
- Flashy
- Teaches us to cleanse our bodies
- Opportunistic
- Resourceful
- Survivor, even in marginal conditions
- Bails out of relationships until well established
- Clever
- Independent spirit
- Natural Leaders
- Impulsive

1: Holzhaahne / Woodcock

- Plant cabbage and other plants in the Brassica family in the Waxing phase up until the Full Holzhaahnemuun.
- Potatoes on the New Holzhaahnemuun or during the waning phase
- Plowing

2: Holzent / Wood Duck

- DIE HOLZENT – WOOD DUCK



2: Holzent / Wood Duck

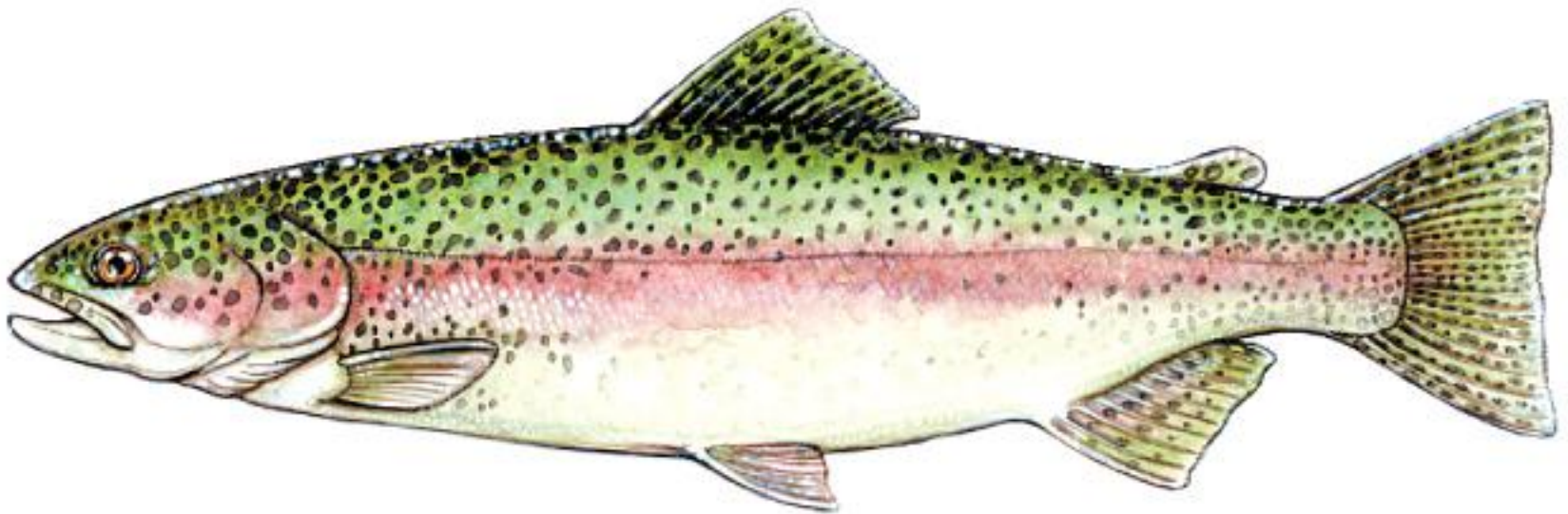
- Metal
- Teaches us to recognize beauty
- Highly adaptable
- Unifier... brings together Air, Water, Earth
- Detail oriented
- Concerned with security...
- ... yet can disregard others' security concerns
- Devoted
- Stubborn

2: Holzent / Wood Duck

- Broccoli, Cauliflower, Brussels Sprouts at waxing Holzentmuun

3: Forrell / Trout

- DIE FORRELL – TROUT



3: Forrell / Trout

- Water
- Teaches us to move with confidence
- Drives on in the face of adversity
- Nostalgic
- Empathetic
- Intuitive
- Indecisive
- Affectionate

3: Forrell / Trout

PLANTING

- Northern Beans during waxing phase
- Gehlwoch: Waxing Gibbous to Full
Forrellmuun – Best time for planting certain types of corn
- Cucumbers (and allegedly best planted by males)

4: Schpeecht / Woodpecker

- DER SCHPEECHT – WOODPECKER



4: Schpeecht / Woodpecker

- Fire
- Teaches us to work with nature
- Persistence
- Attuned to rhythms of nature
- Emotional
- Home-oriented
- Willful suspension of disbelief
- Moody
- Pessimistic
- Loyal

4: Schpeecht / Woodpecker

PLANTING

- Turnips during waning moon
- Squash during waxing moon

HARVESTING

- Begin Haymaking at full moon; ends at new moon of Schillgrott

5: Frosch / Frog

- DER FROSCH – FROG



5: Frosch / Frog

- Venom
- Teaches us to speak for ourselves
- Loud and Proud
- Finances
- Organized
- Frugal, Conservation
- Adaptable, even a little slippery
- Takes control
- Creative
- Generous
- Self-centered

5: Frosch / Frog

PLANTING

- Potatoes during waning Froschmuun
- Corn during waxing Froschmuun

CUTTING

- Cut Canada Thistle at Full Frosch moon so it does not sprout again

HARVESTING

6: Schillgrott / Turtle

- DIE SCHILLGROTT – TURTLE



6: Schillgrott / Turtle

- Time
- Teaches us that frenzied pace cannot be sustained
- Slow and Steady
- Self-Empowered
- Logic and Creativity
- Security
- Analytical
- Hardworking
- Hypercritical
- Shy

6: Schillgrott / Turtle

PLANTING

- Beans in the waxing phase
- Kale in the waxing phase

CANNING

- Earnest process at new moon and continuing until completed

7: Bær / Bear

- BÆR – BEAR



Photo by Hal Korber

7: Bær / Bear

- Spirit
- Teaches us the power of the unconscious mind
- Big- and Deep-thinkers of the Muunraad
- Diplomatic
- Harmony-seeking
- Cooperative
- Social
- Indecisive
- Non-confrontational
- Hates injustice

7: Bær / Bear

- Broccoli and Cauliflower (again) during waxing Baermuun
- Tincturing

8: Fux / Fox

- DER FUX – FOX



8: Fux / Fox

- Salt
- Teaches us to apply our intelligence to the world around us
- Family oriented
- Brave
- Passionate
- Distrusting
- Secretive
- Cunning
- Jealous

8: Fux / Fox

PLANTING

- Native Trees, preferably at Half to Full Fuxmuun

8: Fux / Fox

- Schlachtzeit with New Fuxmuun

9: Eil / Owl

- DIE EIL – OWL



9: Eil / Owl

- Ice
- Teaches us to learn from the world around us
- Idealistic
- Generous
- Affable
- Overpromises
- Impatient
- Blunt
- Humorous

9: Eil / Owl

- Take out six-week tinctures at full Eilmuun

10: Aadler / Eagle

- DER AADLER – EAGLE



10: Aadler / Eagle

- Air
- Teaches us to look within ourselves
- Responsible
- Disciplined
- Managerial
- Unforgiving
- Carries grudges
- Strong-willed
- Honest

10: Aadler / Eagle

PLANTING

- Red beets during the waning moon

11: Grundsau / Groundhog

- DER/DIE GRUNDSAU / GROUNDHOG



Waer hot Bang davor?

11: Grundsau / Groundhog

- Earth
- Teaches us about the true complexity of existence
- Prophetic
- Independent
- Temperamental
- Stoic
- Uncompromising
- Humanitarian

11: Grundsau / Groundhog

- Tool preparation
 - Full moon for aerial tools
 - New moon for underground tools

12: Grabb / Crow/Raven

- DIE/DER GRABB – CROW/RAVEN



<https://www.pinterest.com/pin/307230005803455124>

12: Grabb / Crow/Raven

- Light
- Teaches us about life, death, rebirth, and resourcefulness to ease the process
- Adept at prophecy, magic
- Secretive
- Artistic
- Intuitive – can perceive threats
- Prophetic
- Associated with past lives
- New Grabbmuun indicates wet weather coming

12: Grabb / Crow/Raven

- Field preparation
- Natural fertilization

13: Haa\$ / Hare

- DER HAAS/ES ELBEDRITSCH – HARE/SNIPE



Photo by Patrick Donmoyer

13: Haas / Hare

HAAS – HARE (Southern Deitscherei)

- Teaches us to appreciate youth, hope, and promise
- Highly intelligent
- Fearful OR overly trusting
- Can be a victim
- Vigilant - prone to anxiety – presents as shifty
- Prolific

ELBEDRITSCH – SNIPE (Northern Deitscherei)

- Prolific
- Highly intelligent
- Fearful OR overly trusting
- Can be manipulative or shifty
- Name comes from how the Muun appears and disappears depending on the year.

13: Haas / Hare

- Domestic cleaning
- Animal dwelling cleaning
- This Muun, when in effect, always crosses the Spring Equinox.
- Elbedritsch is associated with shades; Haas with color

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